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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

FTI Consulting

200 Aldersgate, Aldersgate Street

London EC1A 4HD

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Graduate Scheme – Economic & Financial Consulting in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. FTI Consulting's investment in energy expertise within Economic and Financial Consulting, including the appointment of energy economist Emmanuel Fages in July 2026, matches the energy-market research I am doing.

The work I am proudest of follows a consulting arc: diagnose with data, recommend a change, then make it happen. At KONG, I analysed sales patterns and used them to refine our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge in Glasgow, I created the house cocktails and set the specifications for its classics from launch, wrote the batch specifications the team works to, and trained around 15 bar staff, several new to cocktail bartending, to deliver them consistently.

Consulting appeals to me for the range of problems and the standard of thinking it demands: a recommendation has to be structured, evidenced and clear enough for a client to act on. My dissertation applies the same discipline to a broad question, whether governments that hedge oil for their economies change how their currencies react to OPEC news, by breaking it into three testable predictions for Norway, Russia and Mexico and testing each with event studies and difference-in-differences. In co-founding the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I built an organisation from launch to 126 members and led weekly sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC.

FTI Consulting's Economic and Financial Consulting practice stands out to me because its analysis has to survive scrutiny from opposing experts, tribunals and regulators, and because it is building out its energy advice, appointing Emmanuel Fages, an energy economist with more than 30 years' experience across utilities and financial energy markets, in July 2026. Testing my dissertation's predictions with event studies, difference-in-differences and placebo checks is teaching me to build analysis that can be defended line by line.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan